

Red Ranger 2

Jason Lee Scott's second film. It plays the role *Iron Man 2* played for Marvel: bigger stakes, a wider world, and the cost of leading.

Field	Detail
Release date	Friday, August 21, 2015. It returns to the anniversary weekend that <i>Red Ranger</i> opened on, which becomes the Red Ranger's release tradition.
Distributor	20th Century Fox
Rating / runtime	PG-13 / 158 minutes
Real title	Red Ranger 2
Decoy title	Ember Season
Whose film it is	Jason Lee Scott, the Red Ranger

WHY THIS DATE

August 21, 2015

- Late August is the anniversary of the show's August 28, 1993 premiere, and Jason's films own it. The weekend is also clear of *Age of Ultron* (May), *Jurassic World* (June) and *Mission: Impossible – Rogue Nation* (July 31).

01 • TITLE: REAL AND DECOY

Red Ranger 2, shot as Ember Season

- **Real title:** *Red Ranger 2*, a direct sequel title, as *Iron Man 2* was.
- **Decoy title:** *Ember Season*. It reads like a small-town drama, and the burning candle at the center of the film is hidden in plain sight.

02 • WHOSE FILM IT IS

Jason Lee Scott, the Red Ranger

- The film is about Jason carrying the weight of leadership, including literally holding another Ranger's power.
- **Faithfulness lock:** all six Rangers appear at full strength. Zack, Trini and Kimberly get bigger roles, the way *Iron Man 2* brought in Black Widow and War Machine.

03 • WHEN AND WHERE IT'S SET

MGU Year One into Year Two: winter 2013–14

- **When:** winter 2013–14, a few months after *Green with Evil*. The MGU timeline runs slower than the release calendar so the Rangers stay high school students, as they are in the show.
- **Where:** Angel Grove, the Command Center, Rita's Moon palace, and the Dark Dimension, where Goldar guards the candle.

04 • WHAT IT'S ABOUT

The candle burns down

- Rita lights the **Green Candle**. When it burns down, Tommy's Green Ranger powers go back to her. Goldar keeps it in the Dark Dimension, and Jason and Tommy go in after it and fight Goldar at full power. They don't get there in time.
- As his powers fade, Tommy makes the canon choice: he gives his **Green Power Coin to Jason**, so Rita can never take it back. Now Jason holds two coins, two responsibilities and a friend who's been left powerless.
- Rita takes advantage. While the team is a Ranger short, she throws Goldar and her strongest monsters at Angel Grove. Jason has to lead the team, protect Tommy and decide what to do with a power that isn't his.
- **Climax:** Jason gives the coin back to Zordon. Zordon and Alpha 5 restore Tommy's powers, only temporarily, as in canon, and the Green Ranger returns in the final battle to turn it around.
- **Ending:** Jason has learned that leading means sharing the weight. Zordon warns that Tommy's restored power won't last.

05 • VILLAIN / ANTAGONIST

Rita Repulsa at her peak

- **Rita Repulsa** is at her most dangerous. The Green Candle is the best plan she ever executes, and it permanently takes power from a Ranger.
- **Goldar** guards the candle and beats the Red and Green Rangers fighting together. With Finster, Squatt and Baboo, and the Putty Patrol.

06 • POST-CREDITS SCENES

Two scenes

- **Mid-credits: "The Emperor."** Lord Zedd arrives at the Moon palace. Disgusted with Rita's failures, he seals her in a space dumpster and launches her into space, as in canon. Goldar kneels to his new master. The Zedd era begins.
- **End-credits: "The Light."** In a sealed chamber of the Command Center, Zordon and Alpha 5 begin a secret project, a new power built from light. Alpha asks, "Zordon, are you sure?" This sets up *White Ranger*.

07 • SETTING UP THE BIG BAD

Zordon's power can be drained

- Restoring Tommy visibly costs Zordon. It shows that Zordon's own energy can be spent and drained, which is the exact vulnerability Dark Specter exploits when he captures and drains Zordon at the end of the saga.
- Zedd's arrival shows that evil in this universe has a hierarchy and that Rita was never at the top, another step toward the United Alliance of Evil.

08 • ITS OWN WORLD-BUILDING

Jason's world gets bigger

- The Green Candle and the Dark Dimension's rules; how Power Coins can be handed to someone else; the deeper friendships among the original five; and the Youth Center as the team's home base away from the Command Center.

09 • MGU WORLD-BUILDING

The rules every later film builds on

- **Powers can be lost, held by someone else and restored.** That's the basis for every power transfer in the saga, from the Power Transfer to the Zeo Crystal and the Turbo Keys.
- **Lord Zedd** joins the MGU and takes over the Moon palace for the next era.

10 • ITS ROLE IN PHASE 1

How it widens the universe

- It closes Rita's era and opens Zedd's, and its two post-credits scenes set up the Zedd-era films. Fans who've been connecting the dots get their biggest hint yet: these films are building toward something.

This is a fictional, alternate-history development document created for creative purposes. Characters and events follow the original Mighty Morphin Power Rangers series.